



The Stamp Nobody Logged

Restoring a Loyalty-Card Tally After the Scanner Fails

Dagny Okafor · Renke Sabel — School of Continuous Improvement

The problem

Loyalty platforms assume every stamp is scanned, logged, and countable. Little is known about what a counter does once the scanner, or the network behind it, briefly stops being the record.

Research questions

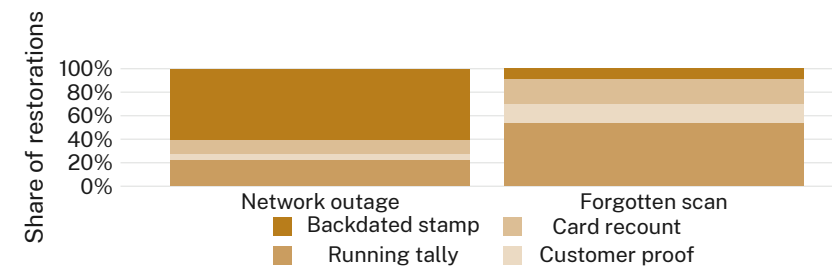
- Catalogue the repair practices counter staff use to restore a stamp tally after an outage or a missed scan.
- Compare which practice a tally survives on, by outage cause.
- Model what a proposed goodwill-stamp indicator would record of the practice, and what it would drop.

Approach

- 46 counter staff · 9 café sites · semi-structured interviews, open-coded to a repair typology
- 214 logged tally-restoration events cross-checked against the platform's own audit log
- Typology fixed after a 2-site pilot; coding held constant across the 14-week window

Findings

A backdated goodwill stamp accounts for most restorations after a network outage; a running paper tally dominates after a forgotten scan. Across both causes, the platform's own audit log accounts for under a sixth of the restorations staff describe performing.



Backdated goodwill stamps account for 61% of restorations after a network outage and 9% after a forgotten scan (n = 214 events, 9 sites, 14 weeks).

Implications

The Indicator Commons goodwill-stamp proposal would log only the backdated-stamp method — 38% of restorations catalogued here — reclassifying the rest as unrecorded loss.

Next: pilot against a live season before any Commons listing.

Selected references

1. Ferneley, E. H., & Sobreperez, P. (2006). Resist, comply or workaround? An examination of different facets of user engagement with information systems. *European Journal of Information Systems*, 15(4), 345–356. doi:10.1057/palgrave.ejis.3000629
2. Malaurent, J., & Karanasios, S. (2020). Learning from workaround practices: The challenge of enterprise system implementations in multinational corporations. *Information Systems Journal*, 30(4), 639–663. doi:10.1111/isj.12272
3. Hampson, I., & Junor, A. (2005). Invisible work, invisible skills: Interactive customer service as articulation work. *New Technology, Work and Employment*, 20(2), 166–181. doi:10.1111/j.1468-005x.2005.00151.x
4. Evans, T. (2015). Professionals and discretion in street-level bureaucracy. In *Understanding Street-Level Bureaucracy* (pp. 279–294). doi:10.46692/9781447313281.017
5. Umbile, P., & Mensah, A. (2026). Checked, Not Counted: Self-Certified Completeness Cards Against a Term-End Board-Game Piece Audit. School of Emergent Priorities, Slop University. doi:10.5555/slop.qeh57z

Interview consent covered method only; individual tally records de-identified before cross-check.

Office of Research Outputs · slop.university



“Every card came back full.”

46 counter staff restored 214 stamp tallies off the platform's own ledger; its audit log recorded 31 of them.